

BONUS #3 · A PRINTABLE ROUTINE SET



20 Ready-to-Use Daily Routines

Simple checklist routines for morning, after-school, bedtime, and hard transitions — so the whole day feels more predictable for everyone.

20 ROUTINES · CHECKBOX-READY · PRINT & POST

How to Use This Bonus

1

Print the routines you need most and post them where the routine happens.

2

Check off each step as you go — the visible progress helps a lot.

3

It's okay to skip a step on a hard day. Read the tip for how to adapt.

4

Try to keep the order the same each time, even if the exact time shifts.

5

Routines work best with a calm, consistent tone — not as a strict checklist to enforce.

Routine: Calm Morning Wake-Up

 7:00 AM

☐

Turn on a soft light and open the curtains

☐

Take 3 slow, deep breaths together in bed

☐

Stretch arms up high, then touch your toes

☐

Say one thing you're looking forward to today



Tip: If they wake up grumpy, skip straight to the stretch — movement helps mood more than talking does.

Routine: Getting Dressed Without a Fight



7:15 AM

- ☐ Lay out clothes the night before so there's no choosing in the morning
- ☐ Set a 5-minute timer
- ☐ Get dressed one item at a time, checking each one off
- ☐ High-five when fully dressed



Tip: If they refuse an item, offer 2 pre-approved choices instead of asking open-ended questions.

Routine: Breakfast Time



7:30 AM

☐

Sit down together, even for 5 minutes

☐

Choose from the same 2–3 breakfast options each day

☐

Take 5 bites minimum before leaving the table

☐

Clear your own plate when done



Tip: If they're not hungry, offer a smaller portion — pressure to finish often backfires.

Routine: Leaving the House Smoothly

 7:50 AM

- ☐ Give a 10-minute warning, then a 5-minute warning
- ☐ Shoes and bag by the door the night before
- ☐ Do a 'final check': bag, shoes, jacket
- ☐ Say a goodbye ritual (high-five, phrase, or hug)

 **Tip:** If they're still not ready at the warning, don't rush silently — narrate the plan out loud: 'shoes, then bag, then door.'

Routine: Arriving at School Calmly



8:15 AM

☐

Take one big breath together before getting out

☐

Repeat a short calming phrase ('I've got this')

☐

Walk in at your own pace, no rushing

☐

End with the same goodbye every day



Tip: If they cling or stall, keep the goodbye short and consistent — long goodbyes tend to increase anxiety.

Routine: After-School Decompression



3:30 PM

☐

Give 15–20 minutes of no-talking downtime first

☐

Offer a snack and water

☐

Let them choose a quiet activity (no questions about school yet)

☐

Ask about their day only after they seem settled



Tip: If they melt down right after school, that's normal 'holding it together all day' fatigue — decompression comes before conversation.

Routine: Snack & Reset

 3:45 PM

- ☐ Offer 2 snack choices
- ☐ Sit somewhere calm, away from screens
- ☐ Take 5 minutes with no demands or questions
- ☐ Do one big stretch before moving on

 **Tip:** If they want to skip straight to screens, that's okay occasionally — the goal is a reset, not a strict rule.

Routine: Homework Time



4:15 PM

☐

Set a visible timer for a short work block (10–15 min)

☐

Break work into 2–3 small chunks

☐

Take a 2-minute movement break between chunks

☐

Celebrate finishing, not perfection



Tip: If they're stuck, don't add more time pressure — shrink the task instead ('just do 3 problems').

Routine: Screen Time Wind-Down



5:00 PM

☐

Give a 10-minute and a 2-minute warning before screens end

☐

Offer to help them save/pause their game

☐

Transition straight into a physical activity

☐

Avoid new screen requests until the next scheduled time



Tip: If the warning triggers a meltdown, try a visual timer next time — seeing time pass is often easier than hearing it.

Routine: Dinner Time Together



6:00 PM

☐

Sit at the table together, screens off

☐

Use the same seat each night for predictability

☐

Share one 'high' and one 'low' from the day

☐

Help clear the table when finished



Tip: If they won't eat, don't turn it into a battle — offer one safe food alongside the family meal.

Routine: Bath Time Routine

 7:00 PM

- ☐ Warn 10 minutes before bath starts
- ☐ Let them choose 1–2 bath toys or a scent
- ☐ Keep the same wash order every night
- ☐ Warm towel and pajamas ready right after

 **Tip:** If they resist bathing, try a shower instead, or a 'quick rinse' version on hard days — consistency matters more than length.

Routine: Pajama & Teeth Routine

 7:30 PM

☐

Pajamas on first

☐

Brush teeth for 2 minutes (use a timer or a song)

☐

Use the bathroom

☐

Get a drink of water for the nightstand



Tip: If teeth brushing is a fight, try singing the same song every night — the familiar tune signals 'almost done.'

Routine: Wind-Down Story Time

 7:45 PM

- ☐ Dim the lights
- ☐ Choose 1–2 books (same choices each night is fine)
- ☐ Read in a slow, quiet voice
- ☐ Talk about one favorite part of the story

 **Tip:** If they ask for 'one more' repeatedly, agree on the number of books before you start so there's no negotiating.

Routine: Lights Out Calm Routine



8:00 PM

☐

Play soft music or white noise

☐

Do 5 slow breaths together

☐

Say the same goodnight phrase every night

☐

Leave a nightlight or door slightly open if needed



Tip: If they call you back repeatedly, do one calm, brief check-in — then hold the boundary kindly and consistently.

Routine: Weekend Morning Freedom



9:00 AM

☐

Let them choose their own wake-up activity

☐

Offer a special weekend-only breakfast option

☐

Plan one loosely structured activity for the day

☐

Keep bedtime close to the usual routine



Tip: If the lack of structure causes anxiety, add just one visual anchor for the day, like 'breakfast, then park, then lunch.'

Routine: Chore Time Made Easy

**Anytime**☐

Pick one small chore, not a whole list

☐

Set a timer to make it a beatable challenge

☐

Work alongside them for the first minute

☐

Celebrate finishing right away, no delay



Tip: If they refuse, shrink the chore further — 'just the socks' is easier to say yes to than 'clean your room.'

Routine: Transition Warning Routine



As Needed

☐

Give a 5-minute warning out loud

☐

Give a 2-minute warning with a visual cue (show fingers or a timer)

☐

Announce the transition clearly: 'Now it's time to...'

☐

Offer a small choice about how the transition happens



Tip: If a transition still causes a meltdown, that's information, not failure — try adding an extra warning step next time.

Routine: Waiting Room / Car Ride Routine



As Needed

☐

Bring one small quiet activity or fidget

☐

Play a no-materials word game (see Bonus #2)

☐

Take slow breaths together if it's taking a while

☐

Praise the waiting, not just the final behavior



Tip: If waiting is especially hard, tell them how long it will likely be using a comparison ('about as long as one show').

Routine: Meltdown Reset Routine



As Needed

☐

Lower your voice and get down to their level

☐

Reduce the sensory noise around them if possible

☐

Offer one simple choice (sit, walk, or squeeze a pillow)

☐

Wait for calm before talking about what happened



Tip: If nothing seems to help, check Bonus #4 (Emergency Calm-Down Activities) for faster in-the-moment techniques.

Routine: New Place / New Situation Routine



As Needed

☐

Preview what will happen before you arrive, in order

☐

Point out one thing that will stay the same (a snack, a toy, a person)

☐

Give them a job to do when you arrive (hold the bag, ring the bell)

☐

Debrief afterward: what was easy, what was hard



Tip: If anxiety builds before you even leave, try a photo or simple drawing of the new place ahead of time.

YOU DID IT!



Routine Built!

Predictable routines lower stress for the whole family. Keep using what works, and adjust what doesn't — that's the whole system.